

comparison

Comparison — how two or more options differ.

10 components: `before-after` · `compare-code` · `compare-prose` · `compare-table` · `decision` · `matrix-2x2` · `obligation-matrix` · `redline` · `split-compare` · `verdict-grid`

What the manifest refactor produced.

BEFORE .

35 layouts scattered across one 10,382-line lattice.css monolith. Per-layout rules grepped, not folder-located. No central metadata.



AFTER .

45 components self-contained at lib/components, one folder each with manifest plus styles plus example plus README. Bundler concatenates per-component CSS; loader exposes the catalog via JSON.

Flat-file lookup versus folder-shape lookup.

BEFORE · FLAT FILE

```
const fs = require('node:fs');
const path = require('node:path');

function loadOne(name) {
  const p = path.join(
    __dirname, 'lib', 'components',
    `${name}.json`
  );
  return JSON.parse(fs.readFileSync(p, 'utf8'));
}

const cards = loadOne('cards-grid');
```

AFTER · FOLDER SHAPE

```
const fs = require('node:fs');
const path = require('node:path');

function loadOne(name) {
  const p = path.join(
    __dirname, 'lib', 'components',
    name, 'manifest.json'
  );
  return JSON.parse(fs.readFileSync(p, 'utf8'));
}

const cards = loadOne('cards-grid');
```

Two options, equal weight, head-to-head.

FIRST OPTION

Two-sentence description of the first option, including the strongest argument for it. Equal-density prose lets the audience compare line by line.



SECOND OPTION

Two-sentence description of the second option, including the strongest argument for it. The `chosen` or `decision` modifier marks the verdict when one has been made.

Where the four substance contracts come from.

SUBSTANCE	AUTHOR WRITES	RENDERER	OUTPUT
prose	headings, paragraphs, lists	Marp markdown → semantic HTML	DOM
structure	nested lists with conventions	lib/*.js post-processor	DOM
series	tabular DSL (axes + datapoints)	chart-family kernel	SVG
graph	external graph language	external CLI (mmdc, future d2)	SVG

What we are doing.

CHOSEN PATH .

Self-contained per-component folders at lib/components, one folder per component. Holds manifest plus styles plus optional transform plus example plus README.

REJECTED OPTION .

Flat files alongside each other in lib/components. Defeats the self-contained goal and leaves transform.js scattered.

Where each component substance lives.

Author-driven · DOM output.

prose — headings + paragraphs
structure — nested lists

Author-driven · SVG output.

series — tabular DSL
graph — external language

Data-driven · DOM output.

(Lattice does not target this cell)

Data-driven · SVG output.

chart-family kernels — radar, quadrant, piechart, gantt, kanban,
progress, timeline-list

Privacy obligations across regimes — neutral grid.

REGULATION	NOTICE	CONSENT	RETENTION	BREACH	DSAR
GDPR					
CCPA/CPRA					
LGPD					
PIPEDA					
HIPAA					
GLBA					

Filled = applies, half = partial, empty = exempt. Neutral ink — data first.

SB-362 rewrote the opt-out link rule.

Cal. Civ. Code §1798.135 · amendment SB-362 (2024)

KEY INSIGHT

A business that ~~collects~~ **collects, sells, or shares** consumers' personal information shall provide ~~two or more~~ **at least one** designated method for submitting requests to opt-out, **including, at minimum, a clear and conspicuous link on the homepage titled "Your Privacy Choices,"** for use by consumers to ~~opt out of the sale of~~ **direct the business not to sell or share** their personal information.

why this matters. SB-362 collapses sale and sharing into one duty and pins a uniform link title — homepage chrome and DSAR workflows both need a uniform UX.

DECISION REQUIRED

Build the data layer or buy it?

Both paths are viable. The difference is where we spend the next 18 months.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

- Full control over schema and roadmap
- 2–3 engineer-quarters to reach feature parity
- Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal

BUY + CONFIGURE

- Ship in 6 weeks, not 9 months
- Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features
- Exit risk manageable — data export contractually guaranteed

RECOMMENDATION

Buy the infrastructure. Build the differentiation. Revisit in 24 months.

Which option meets the criteria.

Folder shape.

- ☒ Self-contained per component
- ☒ Familiar pattern from other libraries
- ☒ Tests can live with their component

Flat files.

- ☒ Less restructuring upfront
- ☐ Per-component grouping by filename only
- ☐ No room for transform.js or example.md

Hybrid.

- ☐ Manifest stays flat, other files in subfolder
- ☐ Splits the component across two locations
- ☐ Defeats the self-contained goal

